# OSHA Bench Grinder Checklist (29 CFR 1910.215)

For inspecting bench and floor stand grinders and for every wheel change

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.215

| DATE | SHIFT |
|---|---|
| INSPECTOR | AREA / EQUIPMENT ID |

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item is marked Defect, keep the machine out of use until it is corrected and record the fix.
3. The machine and wheel manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks.

**Legal basis:** 29 CFR 1910.215: Abrasive wheel machinery (Part 1910 Subpart O, Machinery and Machine Guarding) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-215-abrasive-wheel-machinery

## SECTION A | Guard and wheel exposure

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Safety guard fitted<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(1) | A safety guard is in place over the wheel, unless one of the (a)(1) exceptions applies | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 2 | Spindle end, nut and flanges covered<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(2) | No spindle end, nut or flange projection sticks out beyond the guard | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 3 | Guard alignment<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(2) | Guard sits in line with the wheel and does not shift or rub | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 4 | Guard fastenings<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(2) | All guard mounting bolts present, tight and undamaged, with no weaker substitute parts | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 5 | Exposure angle<br>Ref. 1910.215(b)(3) | Opening is 90° or less (up to 125° only where the work needs wheel contact below the spindle centerline) | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 6 | Start of opening<br>Ref. 1910.215(b)(3) | Opening starts no more than 65° above the spindle's horizontal line | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 7 | Tongue gap<br>Ref. 1910.215(b)(9) | Gap from wheel face to adjustable tongue or top of peripheral member is one-fourth inch or less | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 8 | Tongue adjustment<br>Ref. 1910.215(b)(9) | Tongue or peripheral member still adjusts to follow the wheel as it wears down | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 9 | Visors and accessories<br>Ref. 1910.215(b)(2) | Opening is measured without any visor or accessory unless it is as strong as the guard | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION B | Work rest

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Work rest in use<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(4) | Offhand grinder has a work rest fitted and used to support the work | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 11 | Rigid and adjustable<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(4) | Rest is rigid, not bent or loose, and can be moved in to allow for wheel wear | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12 | Gap to wheel<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(4) | Opening between rest and wheel measures one-eighth inch or less | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |



General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

## SECTION B | Work rest

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | Clamped<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(4) | Rest is securely clamped after the last adjustment | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 14 | Adjusted with wheel stopped<br>Ref. 1910.215(a)(4) | Operators confirm they adjust the rest only when the wheel is not in motion | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION C | Flanges, blotters and fit

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 15 | Flange size<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(1) | Flanges are at least one-third the wheel diameter, or meet the exception for that wheel type | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 16 | Matching flanges<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(4)(i) | Both flanges have the same diameter and equal bearing surface | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 17 | Flange finish<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(3) | No rough surfaces, burrs or sharp edges on either flange | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 18 | Flange wear<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(9) | Bearing surfaces are not worn, warped, sprung or damaged | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 19 | Driving flange<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(7) | Driving flange is tight on the spindle and runs true | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 20 | Blotters fitted<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(6)(i) | Blotters sit between each flange and the wheel, unless the wheel type is exempt under (c)(6)(ii) | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 21 | Blotter coverage<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(5) | Blotters cover the whole flange contact area | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 22 | Clean contact surfaces<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(3) | Wheel, blotter and flange faces are flat with no dirt, chips or debris | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 23 | Wheel fit on spindle<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(2) | Wheel slides onto the spindle freely, without forcing | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 24 | Bushing<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(4) | Any bushing is no wider than the wheel and clear of the flanges | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION D | Wheel check before mounting

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 25 | Visual inspection<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(1) | Wheel examined closely for damage from transit or storage before it goes on | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 26 | Speed rating<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(1) | Machine spindle speed does not exceed the maximum operating speed marked on the wheel | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 27 | Ring test<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(1) | Wheel gives a clear ring when tapped; a dead-sounding wheel is set aside and not used | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 28 | Wheel dry<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(1)(i) | Wheel is dry and free of sawdust when tapped | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 29 | Tap points<br>Ref. 1910.215(d)(1)(ii) | Tapped about 45° either side of vertical, 1 or 2 inches in from the edge, then turned 45° and tapped again | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |


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## SECTION E | Type 27 and 28 wheels

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 30 | Guard position<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(4)(ii) | A guard sits between the wheel and the operator whenever the wheel is used | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 31 | Manufacturer mounts<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(4)(ii) | Mounts the manufacturer fixed to a wheel are not reused | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 32 | Wheel bond<br>Ref. 1910.215(c)(4)(ii) | Wheel is a reinforced organic bonded wheel | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

| Item no. | Defect description | Reported to | Action taken / date closed |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## SIGN-OFF

| | |
|---|---|
| SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service | |
| INSPECTOR SIGNATURE | DATE / TIME |
| SUPERVISOR REVIEW | DATE / TIME |